

Not a netbook

Intel's new processor, Pentium SU2700 and a new Intel G40 chipset were launched at Computex 2009 in Taipei. This processor and chipset combo is aimed towards slim and light laptops not classified as a netbook.

Price Cuts

Apple fans who were waiting for a cheaper MacBook can now rejoice as price cuts in the MacBook and MacBook Pro series have been announced. Even the prices for the MacBook Air have been reduced.

Kingston Media Reader

Jack of all cards

The Kingston Media Reader is a memory card reader that supports 19 memory card formats.

It is grey in colour and has rounded edges. The base of the device has two rubber strips that acts as a grip. The USB cable is attached to the reader and is tucked away at the rear. To access the memory card slots, Kingston has used a slide mechanism, where you need to push the Kingston logo and slide the ports to the front. This logo also lights up in red when a memory card is inserted into one of the slots. The slider mechanism isn't that strong and would have made better sense, if there was a dust cover of some sort. The USB wire attached to the device is rather



short, but an extension has been provided with the pack.

The performance of the Kingston Media Reader was tested by comparing it to the Memory Card reader present in the Samsung R610 laptop. We transferred 1 GB of sequential and assorted data using a Kingston 32 GB SDHC card. The write times of the Media Reader and the laptop card reader were about the

same, but the read times is where the Media Reader overtook the inbuilt card reader.

This product is great as it gives good performance and also supports 19 different types of memory cards. This is a great buy at Rs. 1,099 and will benefit anybody who uses memory cards for data as well as photography enthusiasts who need to transfer data frequently.

Contact

Kingston Media Reader

Phone: +91-22-2659 2927

Email: vishal.parekh@kingston.com

Web site: www.kingston.com/india

Price: Rs. 1,099

Specifications

Cards supported: Compact Flash type I and II, MicroDrive, SD, SDHC, miniSD, miniSDHC, microSD, microSDHC, MMC, MMCplus, RS-MMC, MMCmobile, MMCmicro, Memory Stick, M2, MS PRO, MS PRO Duo, MS Duo.

RATINGS

Features	8
Performance	8.5
Build Quality	8
Value for money	7
Overall	8

AMD Athlon X2 7850 Black Edition

Unlock the potential

AMD has introduced a new line of Athlon X2 7000 series dual-core processors christened KUMA. This line could be considered the low end of their processors, now with the Phenom II processors. We received the AMD Athlon X2 7850 Black Edition to test, which is the most powerful among the 7000 series.



The Athlon X2 7850 BE is compatible with the AM2+ CPU

socket, backward compatible with the AM2 socket but make note that this CPU is not compatible with the AM3 socket. The KUMA architecture is based on the previous generation Phenom X4 processors, and is manufactured with 65-nm process technology with a TDP of 95 W. The specifications of the 7000 series is the same as that of the quad-core processors which means that these CPUs are actually quad cores with two cores disabled.

This processor comes with a clock speed of 2.8 GHz, 512 KB per core of L2 cache and 2 MB of shared L3 cache.

This CPU is a good performer for its price and makes great value for money. Being a Black Edition processor, its multiplier is unlocked, which makes it a good product for gamers and overclockers.

Contact

AMD India

Phone: 1-800-425 6664

Email: fusion.india@amd.com

Web site: www.amd.com

Price: Rs. 3,700

Specifications

Core Clock: 2.8 GHz

L2 cache: 1 MB, **L3 cache:** 2 MB,

CPU socket: AM2+

TDP: 95 W

Bus speed: 200 MHz.

RATINGS

Features	7.5
Performance	7.5
Build Quality	8.5
Value for money	8.5
Overall	8

